Packaging Machine



Category: **Food Processing & Kitchen** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Ice Bar Packaging machine

What it is used for

An ice bar packaging machine wraps or seals ice bars in suitable packaging material for handling and distribution. Correct operation helps protect product hygiene, package integrity and consistent sealing.

Main parts

- Identify the packaging material roll, film holder or feed arrangement.
- Locate the product feeding area and guiding mechanism.
- Identify the sealing jaws, heat-sealing unit or closure mechanism.
- Locate the cutting blade or package separation mechanism, if fitted.
- Identify the conveyor or discharge tray for packaged products.
- Locate the control panel, temperature setting and speed controls.
- Identify emergency stop buttons, guards and electrical isolation points.

Before you start

1. Read the operating instructions and receive supervised training before use.
2. Wash hands and follow the required hygiene procedures for food packaging.
3. Inspect electrical cables, guards, sealing surfaces and cutting components for damage.
4. Confirm that the packaging material is food-grade and suitable for the product.
5. Check that the film roll is correctly loaded and aligned.
6. Verify sealing temperature and speed settings against the manufacturer's instructions.
7. Ensure the work area is clean, dry and free from obstructions.

How to use

1. Switch off and isolate power before loading film or adjusting the machine.
2. Install the packaging film in the specified direction and align its feed path.
3. Thread the film through the guides and sealing mechanism as instructed.
4. Close all guards and ensure the emergency stop is accessible.
5. Switch on the machine and allow the sealing unit to reach its set temperature.
6. Run a test package and inspect seal quality and cutting alignment.
7. Feed ice bars into the designated area using the approved feeding method.
8. Monitor film movement, package alignment and seal consistency during operation.
9. Stop feeding if packages jam, seals fail or film tracks incorrectly.
10. Switch off and isolate power before removing jams or cleaning the machine.

⚠ Safety

- Keep fingers away from hot sealing jaws and cutting blades.
- Never bypass guards or reach into moving feed mechanisms.
- Disconnect electrical power before changing film, clearing jams or servicing parts.
- Use heat-resistant protection when handling hot components after shutdown.
- Keep the control panel and electrical connections dry.
- Follow food hygiene procedures and reject damaged or improperly sealed packages.

Care & storage

- Isolate power and allow hot sealing components to cool before cleaning.
- Remove packaging scraps and product residue using approved cleaning methods.
- Inspect sealing surfaces, blades, film guides and guards for wear.
- Store unused packaging material in clean, dry and protected conditions.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Loading packaging film in the wrong direction or leaving it misaligned.
- Using incorrect sealing settings that cause weak or burnt seals.
- Reaching into the machine before isolating power.
- Packaging ice bars with contaminated material or damaged seals.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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